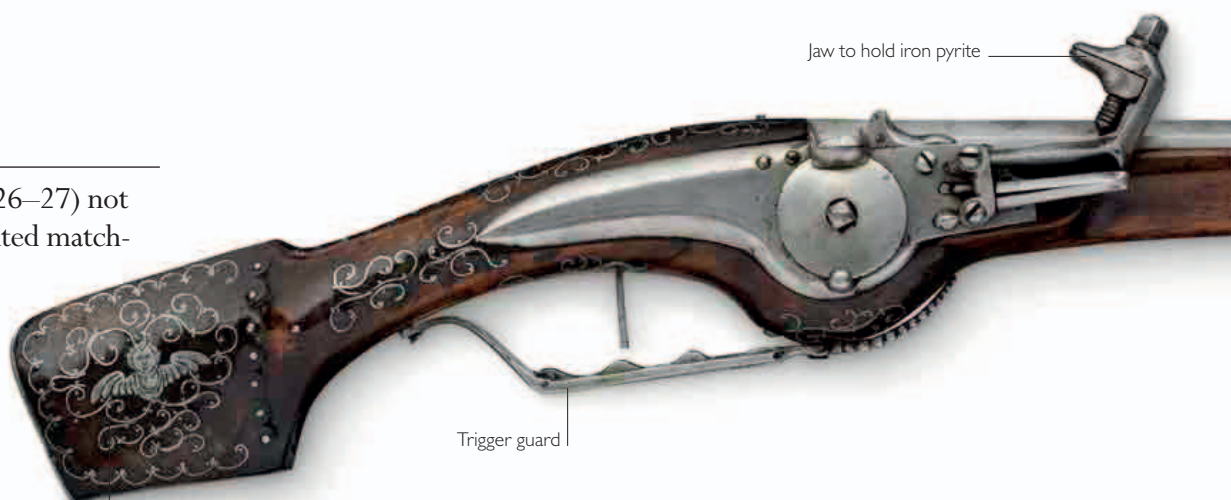


EARLY PISTOLS AND CARBINES

The advent of the wheel-lock (see pp.26–27) not only made it possible to dispense with a lighted match-cord, but now firearms could also be made smaller, be fired with one hand, and carried around, instantly ready to fire. This gunlock made new types of firearms practical. Pistols and carbines appeared. These were lighter than cumbersome muskets and easier to handle. Carbines were shorter than muskets, but larger than pistols, and they provided cavalry with significant firepower.



Trigger guard

Scroll-work in steel wire

▼ HOLSTER PISTOL

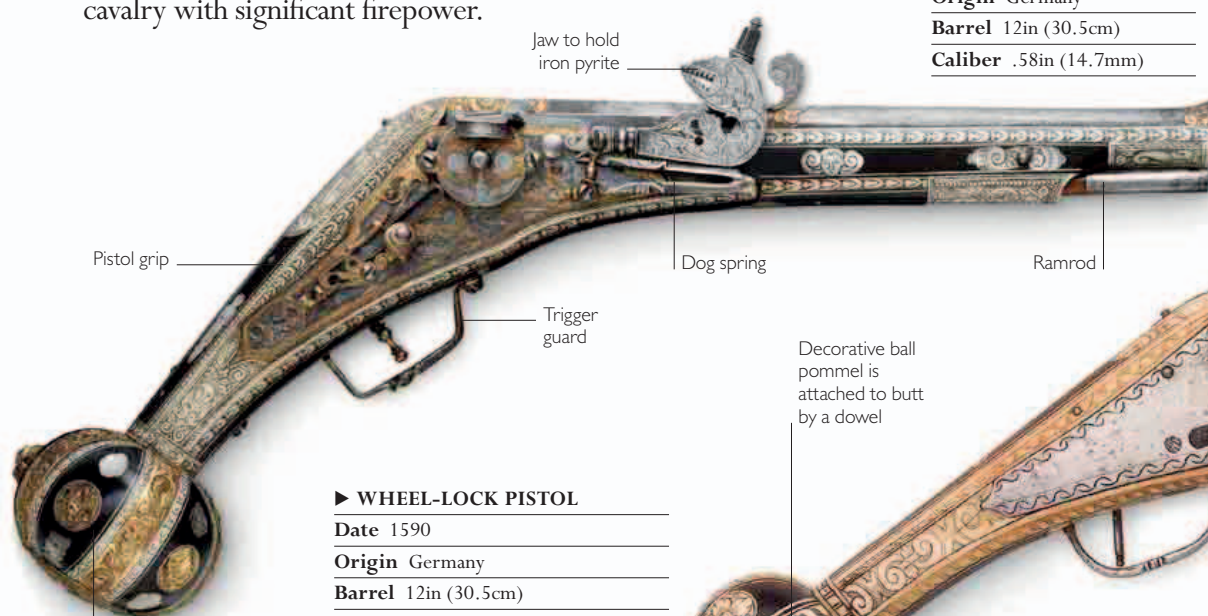
Date c.1580

Origin Germany

Barrel 12in (30.5cm)

Caliber .58in (14.7mm)

This holster pistol has a recognizably angular handgun layout, which meant it could be stored in a holster while on horseback. Every aspect of the gun is highly decorated, including a large pommel at the end of the grip.



Pistol grip

Jaw to hold iron pyrite

Dog spring

Trigger guard

Ramrod

Decorative ball pommel is attached to butt by a dowel

► WHEEL-LOCK PISTOL

Date 1590

Origin Germany

Barrel 12in (30.5cm)

Caliber .50in (12.7mm)

Pommel acts as a counterbalance

In northern Europe, pistols were known as dags (the origin of the name is obscure) until the late 16th century. The ball pommel, a common feature of dags, was designed to make the pistol easier to retrieve from a pocket or bag, instead of being used as a bludgeon.

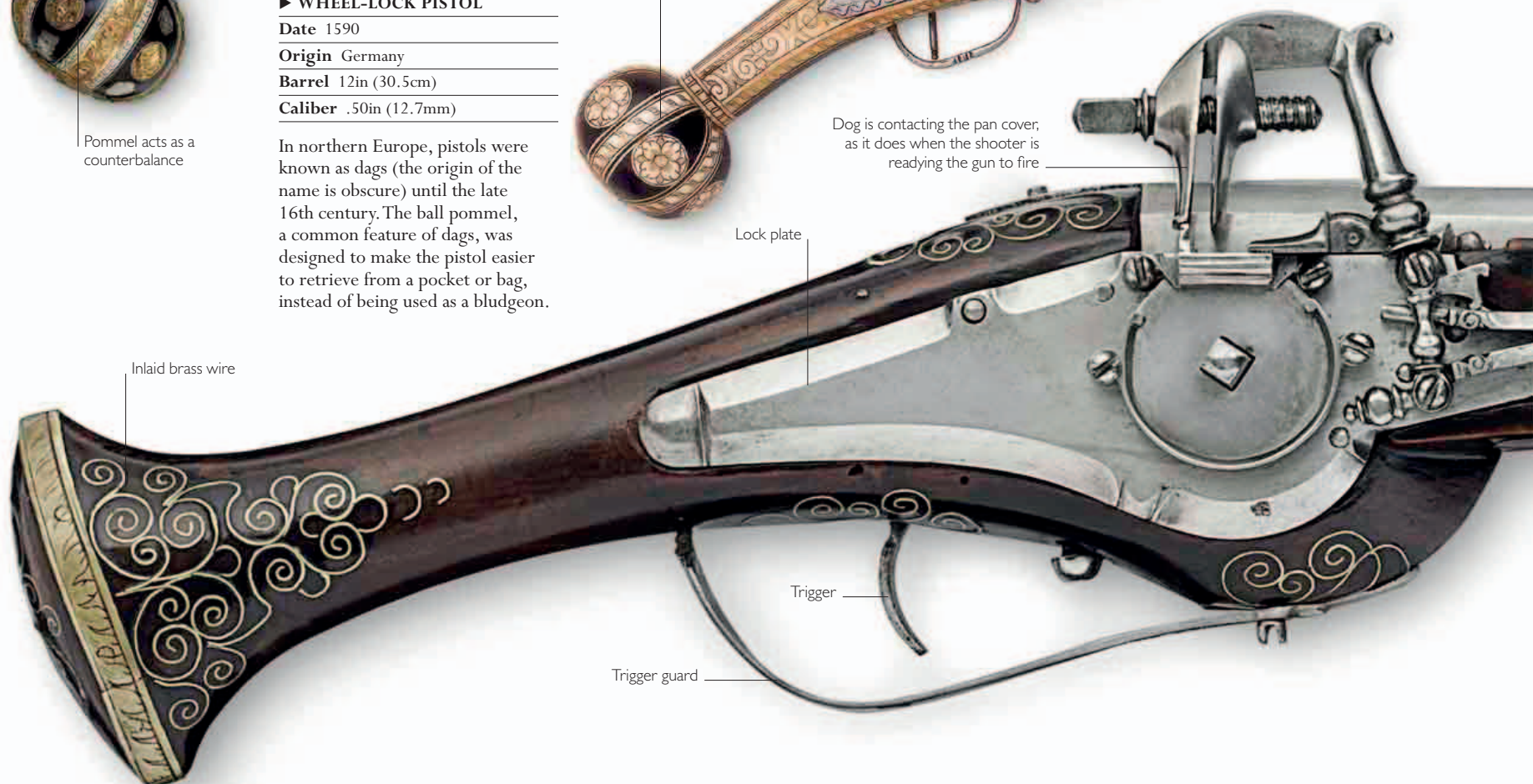


Iron pyrite

Pan

Dog spring

Dog is contacting the pan cover, as it does when the shooter is readying the gun to fire



Inlaid brass wire

Lock plate

Trigger

Trigger guard